

## **Notrump Bidding**

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced\* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced\* distribution

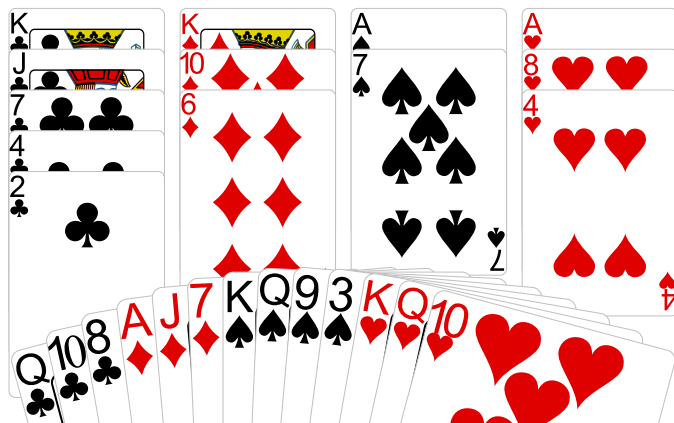
- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

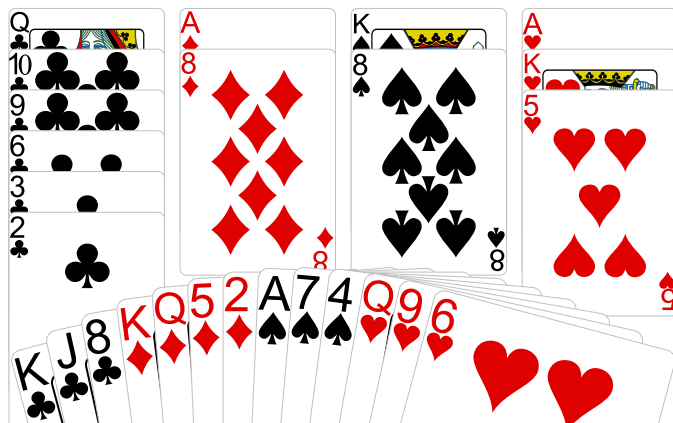
\*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Deal 1 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least \_\_\_\_ winners



| Count Sure Winners            |        |         |          |       |
|-------------------------------|--------|---------|----------|-------|
| ♠                             | ♥      | ♦       | ♣        | Total |
|                               |        |         |          |       |
| Decide How to Develop Winners |        |         |          |       |
| Promotion                     | Length | Finesse | End Play |       |
|                               |        |         |          |       |

Deal 2 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least \_\_\_\_ winners



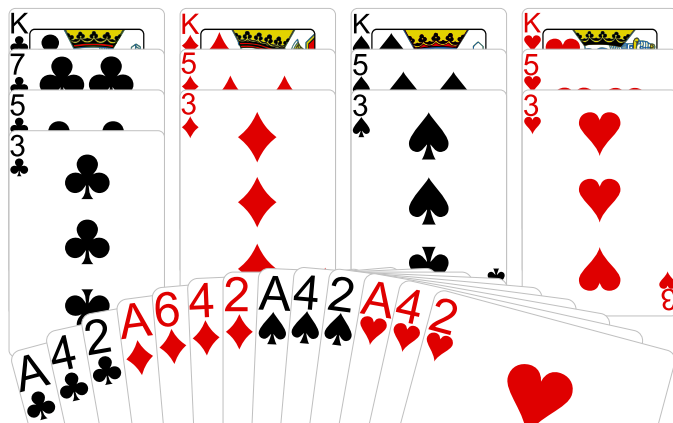
| Count Sure Winners            |        |         |          |       |
|-------------------------------|--------|---------|----------|-------|
| ♠                             | ♥      | ♦       | ♣        | Total |
|                               |        |         |          |       |
| Decide How to Develop Winners |        |         |          |       |
| Promotion                     | Length | Finesse | End Play |       |
|                               |        |         |          |       |

Deal 3 Ctr: 2NT Goal: at least \_\_\_\_ winners



| Count Sure Winners            |        |         |          |       |
|-------------------------------|--------|---------|----------|-------|
| ♠                             | ♥      | ♦       | ♣        | Total |
|                               |        |         |          |       |
| Decide How to Develop Winners |        |         |          |       |
| Promotion                     | Length | Finesse | End Play |       |
|                               |        |         |          |       |

Deal 4 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least \_\_\_\_ winners



| Count Sure Winners            |        |         |          |       |
|-------------------------------|--------|---------|----------|-------|
| ♠                             | ♥      | ♦       | ♣        | Total |
|                               |        |         |          |       |
| Decide How to Develop Winners |        |         |          |       |
| Promotion                     | Length | Finesse | End Play |       |
|                               |        |         |          |       |

Board: 1  
Dealer: **West**  
Contract: 6NT  
Declarer: North

Board: 2  
Dealer: **East**  
Contract: 6NT  
Declarer: East

Board: 3  
Dealer: **East**  
Contract: 2NT  
Declarer: South

Board: 4  
Dealer: **West**  
Contract: 3NT  
Declarer: West

Board: 5  
Dealer: **West**  
Contract: 6NT  
Declarer: North

Board: 6  
Dealer: **West**  
Contract: 1NT  
Declarer: East

**Deal 1**

West Deals  
None Vul

♠ T 6 4 2  
♥ J 9 3  
♦ Q 5 3  
♣ 9 6 3

17  
3 5  
15

♠ K Q 9 3  
♥ K Q T  
♦ A J 7  
♣ Q T 8



♠ A 7  
♥ A 8 4  
♦ K T 6  
♣ K J 7 4 2

♠ J 8 5  
♥ 7 6 5 2  
♦ 9 8 4 2  
♣ A 5

|              |       |      |       |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
| West         | North | East | South |
| Pass         | 1NT   | Pass | 4NT   |
| Pass         | 6NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 6NT by North |       |      |       |

Baker Bidpractice/Set1 19

NORTH has a great 1NT hand - 17 points and 4-3-3-3 shape.

SOUTH has 16 points; he figures it is possible that NORTH can make a slam, but only

if she has a 17 point opener. So he bids 4NT, expecting NORTH to bid 6NT if she has 17 points

but to pass if she has fewer.

He figured right - NORTH had 17 points so she bid 6NT.

**Deal 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 8  
♥ A K 5  
♦ A 8  
♣ Q T 9 6 3 2

6  
16 15  
3

♠ J T 9 6 5 3 2

♥ J 4 3

♦ 3

♣ A 4



♠ Q

♥ T 8 7 2

♦ J T 9 7 6 4

♣ 7 5

♠ A 7 4  
♥ Q 9 6  
♦ K Q 5 2  
♣ K J 8

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by East

Baker Bidpractice/Set1 20

WEST definitely does NOT have a balanced hand. She has two doubletons and a

6-card Club suit.

But she DOES have 18 points, (two extra for the fifth and sixth Clubs), and her 18 added to

EAST's minimum of 15 is enough to bid 6NT.

Notice how easy this will be to play once that Club suit is established.

**Deal 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 7 6 5  
♥ K 3  
♦ Q J 9 5  
♣ A T 3

3  
10 6  
21

♠ K 8 3  
♥ 9 6 5 2  
♦ 7 4 3  
♣ 8 5 2



♠ Q J T  
♥ A J 7  
♦ A K 6 2  
♣ K Q J

♠ A 4 2  
♥ Q T 8 4  
♦ T 8  
♣ 9 7 6 4

Baker Bidpractice/Set1 21

With 21 points and 4-3-3-3 distribution,  
SOUTH opens 2NT.

NORTH has just 3 points; he knows that  
SOUTH cannot have more than 21 so the  
partnership

total cannot be more than 24. So he just passes  
2NT.

| West | North | East | South |
|------|-------|------|-------|
|      |       | Pass | 2NT   |

All Pass

2NT by South

**Deal 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 4 2  
♥ A 4 2  
♦ A 6 4 2  
♣ A 4 2

7  
16 12  
5

West

1NT

All Pass

3NT by West

♠ Q J T 9

♥ Q J T

♦ J 9 8

♣ T 9 8



♠ 8 7 6

♥ 9 8 7 6

♦ Q T 7

♣ Q J 6

North

Pass

East

3NT

South

Baker Bidpractice/Set1 22

This is an easy one to bid.

WEST has a balanced 16 points so he opens 1NT.

EAST has a balanced 12 points so she responds 3NT.

BUT - just look at how this would play. You might only be able to take 8 tricks.

Sometimes correct bidding gets you to unmakeable contracts. But it's only a game.

**Deal 5**

West Deals  
None Vul

♠ T 9 8 3  
♥ A 2  
♦ 9 8 6 3  
♣ T 5 3

20  
4      2  
14

♠ A J 5  
♥ Q T 9 3  
♦ K Q J  
♣ A K 6



♠ K 7 2  
♥ K J 5  
♦ A 7 4 2  
♣ Q J 8

♠ Q 6 4  
♥ 8 7 6 4  
♦ T 5  
♣ 9 7 4 2

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
| Pass         | 2NT   | Pass | 6NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 6NT by North |       |      |       |

**Baker Bidpractice/Set1 23**

Notrump bidding really is easy, you just add your points to partner's points and then

bid according to that answer.

Here SOUTH has 14 points. So when NORTH opens 2NT, showing 20 or 21 points SOUTH knows the

total will come to 34 or 35 so he bids 6NT.



**Deal 6**

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 7 5  
♥ Q 8 4  
♦ Q 6 2  
♣ Q 7 5 3

6  
8 17  
9

♠ 8 4 3

♥ T 6

♦ A J 9 5

♣ J T 8 4



♠ J T 9 2

♥ A J 7 5 2

♦ T 8

♣ K 9

♠ A K 6

♥ K 9 3

♦ K 7 4 3

♣ A 6 2

Baker Bidpractice/Set1 24

WEST cannot open with only 8 points.

Furthermore, when EAST opens 1NT WEST knows that the partnership has a 25 points at most so

he passes again.

West

Pass

All Pass

1NT by East

North

Pass

East

1NT

South